

Marijan Kopčić

Lead Full-Stack Developer & DevOps Engineer · Laravel / PHP · Architecture · CI/CD

mkopcic@gmail.com · (+385) 977 791 402 · marijankopcic.from.hr · Osijek, Hrvatska

Osijek, August 2026.

DICE Digital Innovation Center — Osijek

Application — Backend / Platform Engineering

Dear DICE team,

I'm writing to express my interest in joining your engineering team in Osijek. I'm based here, and one line on your site caught my attention more than the rest: **rooted in Austria, built in Croatia**. That describes my own working reality fairly precisely.

For the past several years I've architected and maintained **WDR Cloud Platform** (willdienstrad.at), a fleet and mobility management SaaS for an Austrian client — built and operated from Osijek. So the model you run as a company is one I've been living as an engineer: Croatian delivery, Austrian stakeholders, everything coordinated remotely and in English. My client contact there has agreed to serve as a reference.

I have 15+ years of backend engineering and production infrastructure experience. I currently lead technical development at Mellon Development, my own consultancy, where I architected and still maintain a portfolio of 20+ production applications and SaaS platforms — including WDR, FitApp (multi-tenant SaaS) and Housespilot (an IoT platform on a headless Home Assistant architecture). Mellon continues as a smaller consulting vehicle, but I'm now looking for a full-time role in an established engineering team.

Backend is where I'd fit first, and I noticed it leads your expertise list. My primary stack is PHP 8.x with Laravel, built on REST API design, service-oriented and event-driven architecture, and relational databases (MySQL, PostgreSQL, MS SQL) including query optimisation, indexing and replication. I also work with Vue.js and React on the frontend, and build cross-platform mobile apps with Laravel Native — useful context given your iOS and Android practices.

Beyond writing code, I own the full delivery chain: CI/CD pipelines with zero-downtime deployments, Docker and LXC, Linux administration across 15+ production servers, and a Grafana/Prometheus observability stack with alerting and incident response. I hold MikroTik MTCNA and CCNA certifications. Over the past year I've also been integrating LLMs into production applications and building MCP agents, and I maintain a published Composer package with 34 tests and a CI matrix (github.com/mkopcic/laravel-bot-protection).

On the leadership side, which I imagine matters in a consultancy: I make the architectural calls, run code reviews, define engineering standards, mentor junior colleagues and communicate directly with clients — translating business requirements into technical decisions and explaining trade-offs to non-technical stakeholders. Your emphasis on collaboration and saying things early and honestly is how I prefer to work.

I'm looking for a long-term position in the city where I intend to stay. My English is fluent (C2), and I have basic German (A2) from working in Germany earlier in my career.

This application comes at the encouragement of **Marinko Dragić**, a good friend of mine and part of your team. He suggested my background would be a good match for what you are building, and I trust his judgement.

My CV is attached. You can also find my work at marijankopcic.from.hr, github.com/mkopcic and linkedin.com/in/marijan-kopcic. I'd welcome the chance to talk about where I could contribute.

Best regards,

Marijan Kopčić

mkopcic@gmail.com · +385 97 779 1402

Osijek, Croatia

MARIJAN KOPČIĆ

Lead Full-Stack Developer & DevOps Engineer

Osijek, Croatia · +385 97 779 1402 · mkopcic@gmail.com
marijankopcic.from.hr · github.com/mkopcic · linkedin.com/in/marijan-kopcic · mellon.hr

PROFILE

Full-stack developer and DevOps engineer with 15+ years of experience building and operating production SaaS platforms. I currently architect and maintain a portfolio of 20+ production applications on self-managed infrastructure, owning the full lifecycle — from business analysis and system architecture through development, CI/CD automation, security hardening, monitoring and disaster recovery.

My primary stack is Laravel (PHP 8.x) with Livewire and Alpine.js, alongside Vue.js and React, REST API architecture and relational databases. Beyond development I'm responsible for technical leadership: architectural decisions, code review, engineering standards, mentoring and long-term modernisation of legacy systems.

Over the past year I've focused on integrating AI/LLM capabilities into production systems, building MCP (Model Context Protocol) agents and intelligent automation. I also build cross-platform mobile applications for iOS and Android using the Laravel Native ecosystem.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lead Full-Stack Developer & DevOps Engineer · Mellon Development J.D.O.O.

02/2025 – present | Osijek, Croatia

- Architecture and development of Laravel SaaS platforms: WDR Cloud Platform (fleet/mobility management), FitApp SaaS (multi-tenant fitness platform), Housespilot (smart-home/IoT platform)
- Integration of AI capabilities and MCP (Model Context Protocol) agents into production applications
- Cloud infrastructure management across 15+ Hetzner Linux servers — Apache/Nginx configuration, automated deployments, cron jobs, backups and monitoring
- Building and maintaining CI/CD pipelines for automated zero-downtime deployments
- Code review, definition of coding standards and technical decision-making
- Database design and optimisation for high-load SaaS environments (MySQL, PostgreSQL, SQLite)
- Containerised environments (Docker, LXC) and virtualisation (KVM/Proxmox)
- Network configuration — firewalls, reverse proxy (Nginx/Traefik), VPN (WireGuard)
- Infrastructure monitoring with Grafana & Prometheus — dashboards, alerting, log aggregation
- REST API development and third-party integrations (payment gateways, CRMs, external APIs)
- Security hardening and performance optimisation across all managed applications
- Cross-platform mobile app development using Laravel Native (iOS & Android)

Tech stack: Laravel · Livewire · Alpine.js · Laravel Native · PHP 8.x · Vue.js · React · MySQL · PostgreSQL · SQLite · Linux · Hetzner · Docker · LXC · Proxmox · Grafana · Nginx · Git · REST API · MCP · AI/LLM Integration

Chief Technology Officer (CTO) · Mellon Development J.D.O.O.

04/2021 – 02/2025 | Osijek, Croatia

- Full-stack Laravel application development — managing development and delivery
- Hybrid cloud solutions, integration of on-premise and cloud infrastructure, resource and security optimisation
- Email infrastructure oversight — setup, configuration and maintenance of mail servers
- Design, implementation and maintenance of network solutions
- Long-term technical strategy and adoption of new technologies

Backend Developer · Future Vision J.D.O.O.

05/2020 – 01/2021 | Osijek, Croatia

- Laravel / PHP full-stack application development
- API and backend applications
- WordPress sites and WooCommerce stores including payment integration

Administrator · Optima Telekom D.D.

01/2018 – 05/2020 | Osijek, Croatia

- Monitoring and reporting for sales agents
- Business and residential sales, administration and process management
- Development of internal sales applications

IT Network & Development · Smart Touch D.O.O.

02/2017 – 01/2018 | Osijek, Croatia

- Software and web application development
- Smart home development and configuration (Control4)
- Network installation, configuration and administration

R&D Engineer · Welove-IT GmbH

11/2015 – 07/2016 | Böblingen, Germany

- Application platform design (NAS+) and network design
- Project manager — PHP and Android applications
- Linux analysis and PHP implementation

Linux Analyst / Software Engineer · OG Consultancy Services GmbH

07/2015 – 12/2015 | Germany

- Linux engineering, PHP implementation, production application support

Team Leader → Tech Support → Network Administrator · Optima Telekom / Optima Direct

03/2009 – 08/2015 | Buje, Croatia

Six-year progression within the Optima group — from call centre agent to team leader and network administrator.

- Leading an ISP call centre team — training, HR processes, interviewing and hiring
- Call centre network administration (110+ workstations, Avaya telephony, Windows/Linux)
- Technical support for business and VIP customers (telco and applications), Jira workflows
- Internal project work: applications, marketing, technical procedures

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Backend & Software Architecture

Laravel (PHP) · PHP 8.x · Livewire · Alpine.js · Laravel Native (iOS & Android) · REST API Design · API-first Architecture · Domain-Driven Design · Service-Oriented Architecture · Event-driven Architecture · Legacy System Modernisation · Performance Optimisation · High-load Backend Systems

AI Integration & Modern Stack

AI/LLM Integration · MCP (Model Context Protocol) · Prompt Engineering · AI Agent Development · Retrieval-Augmented Workflows · Intelligent Process Automation

Platform Engineering, DevOps & Cloud

Linux Server Administration · Platform Engineering · Infrastructure as Code · CI/CD Pipelines · Zero-downtime Deployments · Release Management · Containerised Deployments · High Availability · Disaster Recovery Planning · Backup Automation · Hetzner Cloud · Apache · Nginx · Traefik · Docker · Docker Compose · cPanel/WHM

Networking, Security & Virtualisation

Network Architecture · MikroTik · VLAN · Routing & Switching · Firewall Management · iptables · VPN (WireGuard, OpenVPN) · Reverse Proxy Architecture · Network Segmentation · Security Hardening · DevSecOps · SSL/TLS Management · LXC/LXD · KVM · Proxmox

Monitoring & Operational Reliability

Grafana · Prometheus · Log Aggregation · Metrics Collection · Alerting · Observability · Incident Management · Root Cause Analysis · SLA/SLO Monitoring · Capacity Planning

Databases

MySQL · PostgreSQL · SQLite · Microsoft SQL Server · Database Architecture · Query Optimisation · Index Tuning · Replication · Backup & Recovery · Data Migration

Frontend

Vue.js · React · JavaScript · TypeScript · Blade Templates · Bootstrap · Tailwind CSS · Component-based UI · Responsive Design

Engineering Practices & Leadership

Technical Leadership · Solution Architecture · Code Review · Team Mentoring · Agile/Scrum · Git · GitHub · Bitbucket · Technical Documentation · Coding Standards · Security by Design · OWASP Best Practices

KEY PROJECTS

WDR Cloud Platform · [willdienstrad.app](#)

Enterprise SaaS platform for mobility, fleet and business process management.

- Architecture, development and maintenance of a complete multi-module SaaS platform
- Scalable backend design, API-first architecture and integration services
- Role-based access control, workflow automation and business logic engine
- Database design, performance optimisation and high-availability deployment model
- Full ownership of CI/CD, monitoring and production infrastructure

Tech stack: Laravel · Livewire · REST API · MySQL · Linux · Docker · Nginx · Grafana · Hetzner

FitApp SaaS Platform · [fitapp.cloud](#)

Multi-tenant cloud platform for fitness centres, trainers and end users.

- Tenant-based architecture with per-client data isolation
- Subscription model, user dashboards and automated business processes
- API integrations, background job processing and event-driven workflows
- Optimised for horizontal scaling, security and high availability

Tech stack: Laravel · Livewire · Alpine.js · MySQL · Redis · Queue Systems · Docker

Housespilot Platform · [housespilot.com](#)

Multi-tenant smart-home automation platform built on a headless Home Assistant architecture.

- Platform architecture for lighting, HVAC, blinds, security and irrigation control
- Multi-tenant isolation of users, devices and configuration profiles
- Integration with the Home Assistant ecosystem, automation workflows and real-time event systems
- API design between the application layer, edge devices and automation services
- Security, availability and remote access hardening for production IoT environments

Tech stack: Laravel · Livewire · REST API · Home Assistant · MQTT · Linux · Docker · Nginx

Production Infrastructure Portfolio

Design, deployment and day-2 operations of 20+ production applications on self-managed cloud infrastructure.

- Management of 15+ production Linux servers and cloud environments
- Zero-downtime deployment pipelines and automated release processes
- Monitoring, alerting and observability stack (Grafana, Prometheus, log aggregation)
- Backup strategies, disaster recovery procedures and security hardening
- Network segmentation, reverse proxy architecture, VPN infrastructure and firewall policy

Tech stack: Linux · Hetzner · Docker · LXC · Proxmox · Nginx · Traefik · Grafana · Prometheus · WireGuard · MikroTik

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

MikroTik MTCNA — Certified Network Associate · ZI Media d.o.o.

07/2017 | Osijek, Croatia

CCNA — System and Network Administrator · Algebra

08-12/2011 | Osijek, Croatia

MySQL and PHP Developer · Algebra

08-12/2012 | Osijek, Croatia

Secondary Education — Natural Sciences and Mathematics Gymnasium

1998-2002 | Osijek, Croatia

LANGUAGES

Croatian: native speaker · **English:** C2 — proficient · **German:** A2 — basic

LEADERSHIP & COMMUNICATION

- **Leading technical teams and operations** — years of experience running IT support, coordinating technical teams, allocating work and ensuring timely delivery.
- **Technical leadership and mentoring** — onboarding new team members, internal technical training, code review, knowledge transfer and defining engineering standards.
- **Incident management** — analysis of production incidents, root cause analysis, escalation and implementation of long-term corrective measures.
- **Delivery coordination** — planning, prioritisation, aligning business and technical requirements across the project lifecycle.
- **Systems, network and infrastructure administration** — hands-on planning, implementation, optimisation and maintenance of production environments.
- **Client and stakeholder communication** — technical consulting, translating business requirements into solutions, presenting architectural decisions.
- **Continuous process improvement** — standardised procedures, automation, workflow optimisation and best-practice adoption.